

Costa Rica

Ratio: 3:5 **Adopted:** September 29, 1848 **Usage:** National and State

Blue and white were the colors of the original flag of the United Provinces of Central America



Red, white, and blue recall the colors of the French *Tricolore*

North America



Costa Rica was a signatory to the Declaration of Independence from Spain in 1821, joining the United Provinces of Central America (1823–1838).

The Central American flag remained in use in Costa Rica until 1848 when, in response to events in France, it was decided to incorporate the French colors into the national flag. This was done by adding a central red stripe. The coat of arms was also revised and placed in the center of the flag. In 1906, it was placed in a white disc on

the red stripe, and later on an oval, set toward the hoist.

The coat of arms depicts the isthmus between the Pacific Ocean and the Caribbean Sea. The stars stand for the seven provinces and the Central American union is recalled by “*America Central*” on the upper scroll.

ARMS OF COSTA RICA

